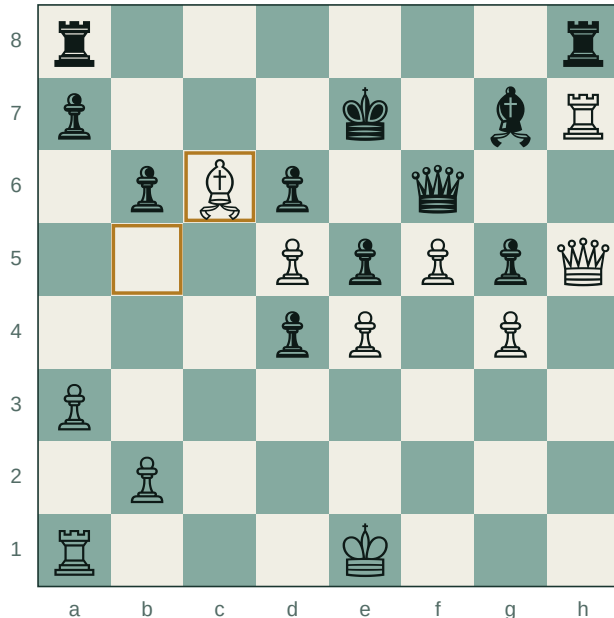


Clearance tactics: Black, move 27

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Rxxh7 28. Qxxh7 Rh8 29. Qxxh8 Bxxh8

27...Rxxh7 The rook captures the rook on h7. Recorded reply: **28.Qxxh7**.

28...Rh8 The rook moves from a8 to h8. Recorded reply: **29.Qxxh8**.

29...Bxxh8 The bishop captures the queen on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.